

KERALA | Show Stoppers



The fratricidal wars in the Malayalam film industry are far from over. The latest is over a diktat by producers and distributors to actors and singers, asking them not to appear on TV shows because it keeps the film audiences away from theatres. Singers and actors, most of who regularly appear as highly paid judges on TV reality shows, have thumbed their noses at the producers' association, the Kerala Film Chamber of Commerce, which has threatened to boycott the rule breakers. Actors are taking on producers by rallying under their union, the Association of Malayalam Movie Artists. "Even prominent playback singers get barely 5-10 songs a year. How can they survive with such paltry money? Let producers ensure singers hundreds of songs and then dictate," said veteran crooner K.J. Yesudas. **by M.G. Radhakrishnan**

MUMBAI | Classroom Act

MUNICIPAL SCHOOLS IN MUMBAI ARE RENTING OUT ROOMS TO NGOS AND POLITICAL PARTIES.

While states are grappling to provide infrastructure under the Right to Education Act, municipal schools in Mumbai are leasing out classrooms to NGOs, political parties and private teaching institutes. The Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) has rented out 2,500 rooms of its 420 schools to various NGOs. The Shiv Sena and MNS unions are using the rooms for free or at a rent of Rs 500. While the BMC school at Elphinstone Road is being used as a residential hub by doctors of KEM hospital, coaching institutes are run from the BMC junior college at Dadar. **by Mitali Patel**

POST OFFICES COULD HAVE TRANSACTION TIMES CUT BY HALF.

DELHI | Alpha Mail

Project Arrow, launched by the Department of Posts (DoP) as part of its make-over programme, could make snail mail trendy again. The DoP has been selected for the Prime Minister's Award for excellence in public administration in the organisations category. About 1,000 post offices (POs) have already been revamped at a cost of Rs 200 crore, while another 500 are on the list

this year. The project aims to improve the core operations of POs and enhance their looks. The highlights? Reduced transaction time at counters from 10-12 minutes to six and digitisation of around 4.26 crore accounts for which 99.8 per cent specimen signatures have already been scanned. Areas like freight, logistics, business and express mail are being spruced with the acquisition of four freighter aircraft.

by Nandini Vaish



THE NEW POST OFFICE BUILDING

DELHI | Batty Stuff

So you think the Mongoose is meant for those with T20/IPL testosterone? This May, the Mongoose men promise, the sequel will arrive. It is the Mongoose meant for Test cricket, but with the same design that makes the MMi3—used in the IPL—the game's genuine 'long handle'. The CoR3 has a blade two inches shorter than the conventional bat, with a splice that is housed completely in its handle. Mongoose want to sign up an Indian soon and GenNext

is on their radar. With a giant sweet spot, who knows, maybe they could hit upon the country's next star. **by Sharda Ugra**



CoR3 (LEFT) AND MMi3